

Cybersecurity Risk Assessment Report

AWAL Global Consults Limited — Internal Self-Assessment

Document Ref: AWAL-RA-2026-001

Date: May 2026

Prepared by: Abdullateef O. Abdulwaheed

AWAL Global Consults Limited

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This cybersecurity risk assessment was conducted by Abdullateef O. Abdulwaheed as an internal self-assessment of AWAL Global Consults Limited, a CAC-registered private limited company providing business consulting, regulatory compliance advisory, data protection guidance, and cybersecurity awareness services in Lagos, Nigeria.

The assessment identified 13 risks across 6 categories. Four risks were rated CRITICAL, requiring immediate remediation. The most significant findings concern NDPR/NITDA non-compliance, collection and handling of sensitive personal data (BVN, NIN) without formal policies, shared credential use across platforms, and absence of documented data processing agreements with clients. This report presents findings, risk ratings, and prioritised remediation recommendations aligned to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0 and the Nigeria Data Protection Act (NDPA) 2023.

2. ORGANISATION PROFILE

Registered Name	AWAL Global Consults Limited
CAC Registration	Private Limited Company — Registered 2026 (Operating since 2022)
Staff Strength	1–4 personnel (management and support)
Location	Lagos State, Nigeria
Core Services	Business consulting, CAC registration, compliance advisory, data protection guidance, cybersecurity awareness, digital transformation consultancy
Data Processed	Names, email, phone, BVN, NIN, residential addresses, ID documents, CAC records, director/trustee information
Systems Used	WhatsApp Business, Gmail, Google Drive, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, CAC Portal, NRS Platform, social media

3. METHODOLOGY

This assessment applied the NIST Risk Management Framework (SP 800-37) and NIST SP 800-30 risk assessment guidelines. Risk scoring uses a qualitative 5×5 Likelihood × Impact matrix. Findings are mapped to the NIST CSF 2.0 functions and the Nigeria Data Protection Act (NDPA) 2023 / NDPR obligations.

Risk Score = Likelihood (1–5) × Impact (1–5) | 1–4 = LOW | 5–9 = MEDIUM | 10–14 = HIGH | 15–25 = CRITICAL

4. RISK REGISTER

ID	Risk Description	Category	Like.	Impact	Score	Rating
R-01	No NITDA registration as Data Controller under NDPA/NDPR — processing BVN, NIN, addresses without legal basis	Regulatory	5	5	25	CRITICAL
R-02	BVN collected and stored via WhatsApp/Gmail without encryption or access controls	Data Protection	5	5	25	CRITICAL
R-03	No formal Information Security or Data Protection Policy in place	Governance	5	4	20	CRITICAL
R-04	Shared passwords used across platforms holding sensitive client data	Access Control	4	5	20	CRITICAL
R-05	No Data Processing Agreements (DPAs) with clients for regulated data	Legal/Compliance	4	4	16	HIGH
R-06	Client data shared via WhatsApp Business — uncontrolled data channel	Data Handling	4	4	16	HIGH
R-07	No incident response procedure for data breach or loss	Operations	3	5	15	HIGH
R-08	NIN and ID documents stored without clear retention or deletion policy	Data Protection	4	3	12	HIGH
R-09	GDPR obligations of international clients not routinely assessed	Regulatory	3	4	12	HIGH
R-10	No formal backup or data recovery plan beyond passive Google/Apple backup	Operations	3	3	9	MEDIUM
R-11	Website (awalglobal.name.ng) security posture not assessed — SSL, hosting, CMS	Technical	3	3	9	MEDIUM
R-12	No staff cybersecurity awareness training documented	People	2	3	6	MEDIUM
R-13	Social media accounts linked to business have no documented access policy	Access Control	2	2	4	LOW

5. KEY FINDINGS & RECOMMENDATIONS

CRITICAL — Immediate Action Required (0–30 Days)

- R-01: Register AWAL Global Consults Limited with NITDA as a Data Controller under the NDPA 2023. Appoint or engage a Data Protection Compliance Organisation (DPCO). This is a legal obligation — non-registration exposes the business to regulatory sanctions.
- R-02: Immediately cease transmission of BVN via WhatsApp or Gmail. Implement an encrypted client data intake process — use password-protected forms or secure portals. Conduct a data audit to locate all stored BVN records.
- R-03: Develop a Data Protection and Information Security Policy covering lawful basis for processing, data minimisation, retention periods, access controls, and breach response. Align to NDPA 2023 principles.
- R-04: Eliminate shared passwords immediately. Use a password manager (Bitwarden — free tier) with unique credentials per platform. Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all platforms — Gmail, CAC Portal, Google Drive, NRS Platform.

HIGH — Remediate Within 60 Days

- R-05: Develop a standard Client Engagement Agreement or Data Processing Addendum that covers data collection consent, purpose limitation, storage terms, and client rights under NDPA 2023.
- R-06: Establish a secure client data intake channel — migrate from WhatsApp to encrypted Google Forms or a secure document portal. WhatsApp is not an appropriate channel for BVN, NIN, or ID document collection.
- R-07: Create a basic Incident Response Procedure: what constitutes a breach, immediate containment steps, NITDA notification obligation (72-hour rule under NDPA), and client notification process.
- R-08 & R-09: Draft a Data Retention and Deletion Policy. Define how long client data is kept, how it is securely deleted, and conduct a GDPR screening question for all international client engagements.

6. NIST CSF 2.0 MAPPING

Risk ID	CSF Function	CSF Category	Recommendation
R-01	GOVERN	GV.RM — Risk Management Strategy	NITDA registration; appoint DPCO; establish legal basis for all processing
R-02	PROTECT	PR.DS — Data Security	Encrypt BVN/NIN data; migrate from WhatsApp to secure intake channel
R-03	GOVERN	GV.PO — Policy	Develop Data Protection Policy and IS Policy aligned to NDPA 2023
R-04	PROTECT	PR.AA — Identity & Access Mgmt.	Password manager + unique credentials + 2FA on all platforms
R-05	GOVERN	GV.OC — Organisational Context	Client DPAs / Engagement Agreements covering data processing terms
R-06	PROTECT	PR.DS — Data Security	Replace WhatsApp data intake with encrypted secure portal
R-07	RESPOND	RS.RP — Incident Response	Draft IRP with 72-hour NITDA breach notification procedure
R-08	PROTECT	PR.IP — Info Protection Procs	Data retention schedule; secure deletion procedures
R-09	IDENTIFY	ID.RA — Risk Assessment	GDPR screening question added to all client onboarding

Risk ID	CSF Function	CSF Category	Recommendation
R-11	IDENTIFY	ID.AM — Asset Management	Website security audit: SSL, hosting config, CMS vulnerabilities

7. CONCLUSION

AWAL Global Consults Limited presents a HIGH-to-CRITICAL overall risk posture driven primarily by regulatory non-compliance under the NDPA 2023, inadequate controls over sensitive personal data (BVN, NIN), and absence of foundational governance documentation. Given that the business processes some of the most sensitive categories of personal data in Nigeria — biometric identifiers, financial reference numbers, and government-issued IDs — immediate remediation of CRITICAL findings is essential.

The good news: all CRITICAL risks are addressable with process and documentation changes — no significant technical infrastructure is required. A 30-day focused remediation sprint can resolve the highest-priority gaps and bring AWAL into basic NDPA compliance.

This self-assessment demonstrates AWAL's commitment to applying the same compliance rigour it advises clients to adopt.

Prepared by: Abdullateef O. Abdulwaheed, Compliance & Risk Advisor

AWAL Global Consults Limited | [linkedin.com/in/abdullateef-grc](https://www.linkedin.com/in/abdullateef-grc) | awalglobal.name.ng